

Shmeera

A secure child check-in and check-out system for your children's ministry

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The Problem

Every service, children's ministry teams face the same high-stakes handoff: a parent drops off a child, and hours later a different adult may arrive to pick that child up. Paper sign-in sheets, sticker tags, and memory don't scale once a room has more than a handful of children, and a single mistaken release is the kind of incident a ministry cannot afford.

Shmeera exists to solve one problem completely: guarantee that only a verified, authorized adult can ever collect a checked-in child, while giving parents a direct, immediate line to staff if their child needs attention during the service.

The Solution

Shmeera is a ready-to-deploy check-in and safety platform built specifically for children's church programs. It runs on any phone, tablet, or browser — no special hardware required — and gives your ministry three coordinated views of the same live data:

- **Guardian (Parent)** — registers children, checks them in and out, manages who else is allowed to pick them up, and messages staff in real time.
- **Staff / Volunteer** — runs a room from a tablet or phone: accepts drop-offs, verifies pickup codes against a photo, messages parents, and raises incidents.
- **Admin / Coordinator** — approves staff accounts, manages rooms and capacity, reviews the full audit log and incident reports, and runs attendance and pickup-time reports.

Because Shmeera is built multi-tenant, your ministry gets its own fully isolated space in the same platform — your families, staff, and records are never visible to any other organization using Shmeera, and setup takes minutes, not a custom build.

How It Works

Drop-off

- A guardian selects the child and room; the app generates a unique, time-limited check-in code (number + QR), sent instantly to the room's staff device with the child's photo, age, and medical/allergy notes.
- Staff matches the child to the photo on file and taps Accept — only that action checks the child in, never the code alone. A printable tag/stub pair backs up the flow for a dead phone or spotty connection.

Pickup

- The parent (or someone they've explicitly pre-authorized, with a photo on file) generates a pickup code; an unlisted adult can never generate one in the first place.
- Staff verifies the code and photo before approving. Any mismatch or failed attempt is flagged to the admin dashboard immediately and logged as an incident.

In-service messaging

- Every checked-in child gets a private, logged chat thread with the assigned room staff — never an unlogged channel. Staff can send one-tap urgent alerts that push through even on silent.
- An unread urgent message automatically escalates to the admin dashboard after a short window, so a runner can be sent to find the parent.

Built on Non-Negotiable Safety Principles

These protections are structural, not optional settings — they hold true for every family, every room, every service:

Principle	What it means in practice
Two-sided confirmation	A code being generated never changes a child's status by itself — a staff member must independently accept or approve every check-in and pickup.
Closed pickup list	Only the guardian, or someone the guardian explicitly added with a photo on file, can ever be presented as a valid pickup option. A person can also be marked explicitly blocked, not just absent from the list.
Single-use, random codes	Every code is cryptographically random, generated per session, time-limited, and never reusable or guessable.
Full audit trail	Every check-in, checkout, decline, failed code attempt, and urgent escalation is timestamped

	and tied to a specific account — searchable by admins at any time.
Staff vetting gate	Staff accounts require admin approval before they can accept a single check-in, with room for background-check status to be tracked per staff member.
Data protection	Encrypted storage and transit throughout, access to medical/allergy notes limited to assigned staff only, and parent-facing tools to export or delete their own data.

What's Already Handled Beyond the Basics

Shmeera isn't a bare-bones prototype — the platform already covers the situations that come up in a real service, not just the happy path:

- Mid-service room transfers (always confirmed by the receiving room's staff) and automatic no-show detection with an admin alert.
- Admin manual-override checkout for a dead or lost parent phone, logged with the approving admin's name, plus camera QR scanning for staff as a faster way to enter codes.
- A persistent notification inbox with optional web push, and admin reporting on attendance, pickup times, and incident history, plus guardian-side data export.

Getting Your Ministry Started

Because Shmeera already exists as a working, multi-tenant platform, onboarding a new ministry does not require a software build — only setup and training:

- 1. An admin account is created for your ministry, and your rooms/classes are configured with age ranges and capacity.
- 2. Staff and volunteer accounts are added and approved by your admin, with background-check status tracked per person.
- 3. Families sign up, add their children and any authorized pickup people, and complete consent at registration.
- 4. A short training session walks staff through accepting a drop-off and approving a pickup — the workflow is designed to take under a minute to learn.
- 5. Your ministry runs a live service with Shmeera, with the printed tag/stub fallback available from day one for any family without a smartphone.

Roadmap

The current platform fully covers check-in, checkout, messaging, and audit. Known, deliberate next steps — not gaps in the core safety model — include SMS escalation as a fallback alongside push notifications, an offline-sync mode for venues with no connectivity at all, and direct integration with a third-party background-check provider in place of today's manually-set status field.

Investment

Pricing is scoped to the size of your ministry — number of children served and rooms staffed — and is intended to be simple to budget for. The structure below is a starting point for discussion:

	Setup	Ongoing
Included	Account setup, room configuration, staff onboarding, and a live training session	Hosting, support, and all platform updates
Terms	[To be discussed]	[To be discussed — flat or per-child pricing available]

Final pricing will be confirmed together based on your ministry's size and any customization you'd like.

Why Shmeera

Children's ministry safety shouldn't depend on a volunteer's memory or a clipboard sign-in sheet. Shmeera gives your team a system where a mismatched pickup simply cannot happen silently, where every action is accountable, and where a parent is never more than a tap away from the room their child is in.

We'd welcome the chance to walk your team through a live demo and answer any questions.

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